

Marialexandra Horna Arrieta

mhornaa22@gmail.com / mh4850@columbia.edu • [linkedin.com/in/alehorna](https://www.linkedin.com/in/alehorna)

Education

Master of Science in Climate Finance, Columbia University 2026 – 2027

Stanley Park Scholar (full-tuition merit-based scholarship; awarded to 3 students per cohort).

Relevant coursework: Corporate Finance, Capital Markets Investments, Foundations of Valuation (Black-Scholes, CAPM, DCF), Climate Finance, Climate Risk, International Climate Finance.

Bachelor's in Economics, Universidad del Pacifico (Peru) 2018 – 2022

Top third of graduating class. Major: Development Economics & Finance.

Professional Experience

Climate Investment Associate, IDB Lab (Peru) Oct 2025 – Present

- Source and assess equity, debt, and blended finance opportunities for climate and energy investments across 7 Latin American countries, including conducting due diligence, financial modeling, market analysis, and preparing investment memorandum for internal committees.
- Structure equity and debt transactions in coordination with governments, accelerators, and private investors, designing blended finance mechanisms to de-risk investments in climate-resilient agriculture, circular economy, and clean technology.
- Manage and monitor a portfolio with GEF across multiple geographies, conducting risk assessments and supporting technical assistance to strengthen governance and financial performance
- Contribute to the development and execution of IDB Lab's climate investment strategy, supporting pipeline development and strategic alignment across regional operations.

Green Investment Analyst, GPD Partners (Peru) Apr 2025 – Sep 2025

- Managed a USD 14M portfolio in sustainable agriculture, water management, and climate-resilient infrastructure, balancing financial performance targets with environmental impact objectives across 12 active investments.
- Originated and structured 12 debt and equity transactions for SMEs and agricultural cooperatives, producing financial models and risk assessments that informed USD 6M in investment decisions.
- Led ESG due diligence for 8 potential investees, evaluating biodiversity impacts, climate adaptation measures, and supply-chain vulnerabilities in high-risk geographies across Peru and Ecuador.
- Developed KPI and impact-reporting frameworks aligned with IFC Performance Standards, IRIS+, and SDGs, while providing technical assistance to portfolio companies on financial planning and climate-smart agricultural practices.

Junior Technical Advisor, German Development Agency – GIZ (Peru) Jul 2023 – Mar 2025

- Co-designed Peru's Green Taxonomy in coordination with Ministry of Economy, financial regulators, and 15 commercial banks—the first comprehensive framework for green investment classification in the Andean region.
- Developed Peru's National Green Finance Roadmap, structuring a pipeline of instruments expected to mobilize USD 100M+ in sustainable infrastructure and climate adaptation finance.
- Facilitated 12 multi-stakeholder workshops integrating biodiversity indicators, climate vulnerability data, and socio-economic considerations to build consensus on technical thresholds and implementation pathways.

Institutional Funding Intern, CAF (Peru) Oct 2022 – Jan 2023

- Supported resource mobilization efforts that secured USD 10M+ in non-reimbursable climate and biodiversity funds from multilateral mechanisms including the Green Climate Fund, Global Environment Facility, and bilateral donors (KfW, AFD, AECID).
- Mapped 30+ co-financing opportunities across Latin America, analyzing eligibility requirements, grant conditions, and strategic alignment with CAF's climate portfolio to optimize funding structures for blended finance operations.
- Drafted 5 project proposals with theory of change frameworks, results matrices, and monitoring indicators for sustainability initiatives in the Andean region, while coordinating with 10+ international organizations on financing terms and reporting standards.

Research & Publication

Horna, M. (2025). "The Effects of Voluntary Sustainability Certifications on Non-traditional Agroexports in Peru." *Journal of Business*, Universidad del Pacífico.

Peer-reviewed publication analyzing the causal impact of GlobalGAP certification on export performance of Peruvian agro-firms using propensity score matching and difference-in-differences methods. Findings demonstrate that certification increases export values by 18-22% but effects vary significantly by firm size and destination market, with implications for public support programs targeting smallholder competitiveness.

Conference Presentations:

- "Sustainability Certifications and Agro-Export Competitiveness," International Conference on Trade, Investment, Finance and Sustainable Development in EU-LAC Relations, Buenos Aires, November 2025
- "Voluntary Certifications and Inclusive Growth in Agriculture," I° IKSAD International Congress on Social Sciences, Lima, June 2025

Academic Engagement:

- Member, Visionarios Academic Circle — Latin American research consortium promoting applied economic research and interdisciplinary policy dialogue across regional universities, August 2025.

Technical Skills & Certifications

Languages: Spanish (Native), English (Advanced), German (Advanced), Portuguese (Intermediate)

Certifications: CFA Institute - Climate Risk, Valuation, and Investing Certificate (Sept. 2025); Frankfurt School of Finance & Management - Green Finance Certificate (2023); Bloomberg - Market Concepts & ESG Certificate (2021)

Specializations: Impact investing, ESG integration, development finance, econometric analysis.

Leadership, Awards & Recognition

Emerging Women Investors in Latin America , LAVCA **2025**

Selected among 306 junior-level investment professionals across Latin America by the Latin American Venture Capital Association (LAVCA), recognizing contribution to the region's climate finance and private capital ecosystem through active investment role in structuring transactions and due diligence.

Youth Ambassador for Climate Action, COP Peru Operation **2024**

Selected as one of 35 youth ambassadors nationwide. Participated in high-level training on international climate negotiations, contributed to capacity-building initiatives, and represented youth perspectives in discussions on Peru's climate and biodiversity agenda.

Academic Director, Peruvian Association of Economics Students (APEECO) **2020 – 2021**

Responsible for opinion articles, academic essays, economic reports, and moderator of debates on economics. A non-profit civil association with over 35 economics faculties promoting civic participation among the university community.

Honorary Member & Debate Finalist, University Debate Team (CIDEUP) **2019 – 2020**

Finalist in 2019 Latin American University Tournament (British Parliamentary). Promoted civic participation through competitive debate and public speaking.